

Complete Theme

Vocabulary — 24 words

Word	IPA	Turkish	Example
achievement <i>noun</i>	/əˈtʃiːvmənt/	başarı	By the time she turned thirty, she had already had several achievements in her career.
memorable <i>adjective</i>	/ˈmemərəbl/	unutulmaz	The trip to the coast had been one of the most memorable events of his childhood.
childhood <i>noun</i>	/ˈtʃaɪldhʊd/	çocukluk	She had spent most of her childhood in a small village before her family moved to the city.
upbringing <i>noun</i>	/ˈʌpbriŋɪŋ/	yetiştirilme tarzı	His strict upbringing had shaped the way he made decisions later in life.
eventually <i>adverb</i>	/ɪˈventʃuəli/	sonunda	After years of practice, she eventually became a professional pianist.
background <i>noun</i>	/ˈbækgraʊnd/	geçmiş, özgeçmiş	By the time he applied for the job, he had already built a strong background in engineering.
encounter <i>noun/verb</i>	/ɪnˈkaʊntər/	karşılaşma; karşılaşmak	Their first encounter had taken place many years before they became close friends.
recall <i>verb</i>	/rɪˈkɔːl/	hatırlamak	She could still recall how nervous she had felt on her first day at school.
reunion <i>noun</i>	/riːˈjuːniən/	yeniden buluşma	By the time of the reunion, most of the old classmates had already changed a lot.
relocate <i>verb</i>	/ˌriːləʊˈkeɪt/	yer değiştirmek, taşınmak	They had relocated twice before they finally settled in the coastal town.
hardship <i>noun</i>	/ˈhɑːrdʃɪp/	zorluk, sıkıntı	The family had faced great hardship before things finally improved.
milestone <i>noun</i>	/ˈmaɪlstəʊn/	dönüm noktası	Graduating from university was a milestone she had worked toward for years.
witness <i>verb/noun</i>	/ˈwɪtnəs/	tanık olmak; tanık	By the time she arrived, the crowd had already witnessed the whole event.
vivid <i>adjective</i>	/ˈvɪvɪd/	canlı, net	He still had a vivid memory of the storm that had hit the village years earlier.
nostalgic <i>adjective</i>	/noˈstældʒɪk/	nostaljik, özlem dolu	Looking at the old photos made her feel nostalgic about the place she had grown up in.

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faded <i>adjective</i>	/ˈfeɪdɪd/	solmuş, sönük	The house had faded paint because no one had repainted it for years.
abandoned <i>adjective</i>	/əˈbændənd/	terk edilmiş	The building had been abandoned long before the town decided to restore it.
cherish <i>verb</i>	/ˈtʃerɪʃ/	değer vermek, sevmek	She had always cherished the summers she had spent at her grandmother's farm.
unexpectedly <i>adverb</i>	/ˌʌnɪkˈspektɪdli/	beklenmedik bir şekilde	He unexpectedly met an old friend he had not seen for ten years.
resilient <i>adjective</i>	/rɪˈzɪliənt/	dirençli, dayanıklı	After everything she had gone through, she remained remarkably resilient.
overcome <i>verb</i>	/ˌəʊvərˈkʌm/	üstesinden gelmek	He had overcome many difficulties before he finally achieved his dream.
generation <i>noun</i>	/ˌdʒenəˈreɪʃn/	kuşak, nesil	Her grandmother's generation had experienced a very different way of life.
legacy <i>noun</i>	/ˈlegəsi/	miras	By the time he passed away, he had left behind an impressive legacy.
transform <i>verb</i>	/trænsˈfɔːrm/	dönüştürmek	The small town had transformed completely by the time she returned.

Past Perfect (had + past participle)

We form the Past Perfect with had + the past participle of the verb. We use it for an action that happened before a specific past time, or before another past action.

Past Perfect, had + fiilin üçüncü hali (past participle) ile oluşturulur. Belirli bir geçmiş zamandan önce ya da geçmişteki başka bir olaydan önce gerçekleşen bir eylemi anlatmak için kullanılır.

When? We use the Past Perfect to show the earlier of two past actions, often with time markers like 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time', 'when' and 'never...before'.

İki geçmiş eylemden daha önce gerçekleşeni belirtmek için Past Perfect kullanılır; genellikle 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time', 'when' ve 'never...before' gibi zaman ifadeleriyle birlikte kullanılır.

Positive

- She had finished the report before the meeting started.
- They had already left when we arrived.

Negative

- He had not seen the message before he replied.
- We hadn't visited that city before last summer.

Question

- Had you finished your homework before dinner?
- Had she ever travelled abroad before that trip?

Short answers

- Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.
- Yes, she had. / No, she hadn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~When I arrived, the film already started.~~ → **When I arrived, the film had already started.**
- ~~She had went to Paris before she moved to London.~~ → **She had gone to Paris before she moved to London.**
- ~~By the time he was twenty, he lived in three countries.~~ → **By the time he was twenty, he had lived in three countries.**

1. By the time she was eighteen, she _____ (travel) to five different countries.

2. Choose the correct sentence.

- a. When we got home, it started to rain.
- b. When we got home, it had started to rain.
- c. When we got home, it has started to rain.
- d. When we got home, it starts to rain.

3. She had never met him before that party. — True / False

4. He _____ his keys, so he couldn't get into the house.

- a. lost
- b. had lost
- c. loses
- d. has lost

5. Put the words in order: (already / the / had / bus / left / when / I arrived)

6. _____ you ever _____ (be) to that museum before last week's trip?

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7. Combine using the Past Perfect: The train left. I got to the station five minutes later. (*By the time...*)

8. Which sentence uses the Past Perfect correctly?

- a. I hadn't eaten anything before the show start.
- b. I hadn't eaten anything before the show started.
- c. I don't eaten anything before the show started.
- d. I not ate anything before the show started.

9. Rewrite as one sentence using the Past Perfect: She finished her project. Then she went to bed. (*After...*)

10. The city _____ completely (change) by the time she returned after twenty years abroad.

11. Choose the best continuation: 'By the time the film finished, most of the audience...'

- a. fell asleep.
- b. had fallen asleep.
- c. falls asleep.
- d. has fallen asleep.

Past Perfect with time expressions (before, after, already, by the time, never...before)

Time expressions such as 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time' and 'never...before' are often used with the Past Perfect to make the sequence of past events clear.

'Before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time' ve 'never...before' gibi zaman ifadeleri, geçmişteki olayların sırasını netleştirmek için genellikle Past Perfect ile birlikte kullanılır.

When? We choose the time expression depending on which action we want to highlight as earlier, and we combine it with the Past Perfect for that earlier action.

Hangi eylemin daha önce gerçekleştiğini vurgulamak istediğimize göre zaman ifadesini seçeriz ve bu daha önceki eylemi Past Perfect ile birleştiririz.

Positive

- By the time we got there, the show had already begun.
- After she had finished her studies, she started working.

Negative

- Before the interview, he hadn't prepared any questions.
- By the time I called, they hadn't left yet.

Question

- Had you ever visited that country before your trip last year?
- By the time you got home, had your family already eaten?

Short answers

- Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.
- Yes, they had. / No, they hadn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~By the time she arrived, we finish the cake.~~ → **By the time she arrived, we had finished the cake.**
- ~~It was the first time I have seen snow.~~ → **It was the first time I had seen snow.**

- ~~After she had arrived home, she was calling her mother.~~ → **After she had arrived home, she called her mother.** AbOnlinEnglish Upper Secondary — 11. Sınıf — Complete Theme · Orijinal içerik, TYMM müfredatıyla uyumlu.

1. _____ the time she called, I _____ (already leave) the office.
2. It was the first time he _____ a live concert.
 - a. saw
 - b. had seen
 - c. has seen
 - d. sees
3. After they had eaten dinner, they went for a walk. — *True / False*
4. Join using 'before': She locked the door. Then she left the house.
5. Choose the correct sentence.
 - a. Never before I had travelled so far.
 - b. I had never travelled so far before.
 - c. I have never travelled so far before that.
 - d. I never had travelled so far before.
6. Combine with 'by the time': The guests left. We hadn't cleaned the kitchen yet.
7. It was the first time she _____ (be) responsible for organising an event on her own.

The Teacher Who Never Gave Up

Before you read

- Look at the title. What kind of life story do you expect to read?
- Have you ever heard of someone who overcame great hardship to succeed?

By the time Elif turned forty, she had already achieved something that few people from her small village had ever managed: she had become the headteacher of the region's largest school. But her path there had not been easy.

Elif had grown up in a mountain village where, at the time, few girls had continued their education beyond primary school. Her parents had never gone to secondary school themselves, but they had always believed that education could change their daughter's future. By the time she was twelve, Elif had already decided that she wanted to become a teacher, even though nobody in her family had ever worked in education before.

After she had finished secondary school in the nearest town, she had to travel two hours by bus every day to attend university. She later said that by the time she graduated, she had missed countless family events and had faced financial hardship that had tested her more than once. Still, she had never given up on her goal.

Her first teaching post had been in a small rural school that had not had enough books or equipment. Elif had spent her own savings buying materials for her students. Within a few years, word of her dedication had spread, and by the time a position opened at the regional school, she had already built a reputation as one of the most resilient teachers in the area.

Today, when Elif looks back, she says that everything she had gone through had shaped the teacher she eventually became. Her story has become an inspiration for many young people in her village who now believe that, like her, they too can overcome hardship and reach their own milestones.

1. What had Elif achieved by the time she turned forty?
 - a. She had opened her own school.
 - b. She had become the headteacher of the region's largest school.
 - c. She had written a book about education.
 - d. She had moved to a different country.
2. Elif's parents had studied at secondary school themselves. — *True / False*
3. By the time she was twelve, Elif had already _____ that she wanted to become a teacher.
4. What had Elif done with her own savings?
 - a. She had bought a house.
 - b. She had paid for her university fees.
 - c. She had bought materials for her students.
 - d. She had donated them to her village.
5. Explain in your own words why Elif's journey to becoming a teacher had not been easy. (*Elif's journey had not been easy because...*)

After you read

- Do you know anyone whose life story resembles Elif's? What made them resilient?
 - What milestone would you like to have achieved by the time you are forty?
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A Return to the Abandoned House

Before you read

- Predict: why might someone want to return to a place they lived in as a child?
- What feelings do old, abandoned places often create?

When Kerem parked his car in front of the old house, he felt a wave of nostalgia. He had not visited the place since his family had relocated to the city twenty years earlier, and by the time he got out of the car, memories he had almost forgotten had already begun to return.

The house looked very different from how he remembered it. The garden his grandfather had once carefully looked after had become overgrown, and the walls, which had been painted a bright blue when he was a child, were now faded and cracked. Someone had clearly abandoned the property years before, and nature had slowly taken it back.

Kerem walked through what had once been the kitchen. He recalled that his grandmother had always been cooking something there, and the smell of fresh bread had filled the whole house every morning. He remembered that, before he had even woken up, she had usually already prepared breakfast for the whole family.

In the corner of the main room, Kerem found an old wooden chest that his family had left behind when they had moved. Inside, he discovered photographs that had faded over the decades, along with a notebook his grandfather had written in. As he read the pages, he realised how much of his family's history he had never known before that moment.

Kerem left the house that afternoon feeling that, although the building had changed completely, the memories it held had not faded at all. He decided that he would come back again soon, this time bringing his own children so they could learn about the place their family had once called home.

1. How long had it been since Kerem had visited the house?
 - a. Ten years
 - b. Fifteen years
 - c. Twenty years
 - d. Thirty years
2. The garden had been well cared for by the time Kerem returned. — *True / False*
3. Before Kerem had even woken up, his grandmother had usually already _____ breakfast.
4. What did Kerem find in the old wooden chest?
 - a. Old clothes and toys
 - b. Photographs and a notebook
 - c. Money and jewellery
 - d. Letters and a map
5. In your own words, explain what Kerem decided to do at the end of the story and why. (*At the end, Kerem decided...*)

After you read

- Have you ever returned to a place from your childhood? What had changed?

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- Why do you think old family objects, like photographs or notebooks, matter to people?

Catching Up After Many Years

Before you listen

- What do old friends usually talk about when they meet after a long time?
- Predict two things the speakers might mention that had happened before they met again.

1. Why hadn't A and B seen each other?

- a. They had had an argument.
- b. They had lost contact since finishing university.
- c. They had moved to different countries permanently.
- d. They had never actually met before.

2. Before getting her current job, A had worked abroad for three years. — *True / False*

3. By the time she left, A had actually _____ a new language too.

4. What had B already started by the time he turned thirty?

- a. A new job
- b. A family
- c. His own small business
- d. A university course

A Grandmother's Story

Before you listen

- What kinds of stories do grandparents often tell about their own past?
- Listen for the order of events in the grandmother's life.

1. What had the grandmother already done by the age of eighteen?

- a. Got married
- b. Left her home town to study
- c. Started working as an engineer
- d. Had children

2. The grandmother had known the grandfather for many years before they married. — *True / False*

3. By the time they celebrated their first anniversary, they had already _____ three times.

4. According to the story, what had shaped the grandmother into a resilient person?

- a. Her university studies
- b. All her different experiences moving to new cities
- c. Her career as an engineer
- d. Her time as a teacher

My Life Before This Moment

Pairs · 8-10 min

Tell your partner about three things that had already happened in your life before you started this school year, using the Past Perfect.

Useful language: By the time I started this year, I had already..., Before that, I had never..., I had just... when..., It was the first time I had ever...

1. Think of three events or achievements from your life before this school year began.
2. Prepare one or two sentences about each event using the Past Perfect.
3. Take turns telling your partner your three events; your partner listens and asks one follow-up question about each.
4. Swap roles so both partners get a turn to speak and to ask questions.

The Place I Remember

Groups of 3-4 · 10 min

Describe a memorable place from your past to your group, explaining what it had looked like and what had happened there before it changed or before you left it.

Useful language: The place I remember most is..., Before it changed, it had been..., I had spent a lot of time there because..., By the time I last saw it, it had already...

1. Think of a place from your past (a house, a school, a neighbourhood) that has changed or that you no longer visit.
2. Note down two or three details about what the place had been like and what had happened there.
3. Describe the place to your group, using the Past Perfect where appropriate to show earlier events.
4. Group members ask one question each about the place after the description.

Writing

A Memorable Day

120-150 words

Write a short narrative about a memorable day in your past, making it clear what had already happened before the main event of the day.

Plan:

1. Choose the memorable day you will write about.
2. List two or three things that had already happened before the main event of that day.
3. Decide on the order of events and which time expressions to use.
4. Write a short paragraph, then check your verb forms.

Checklist:

- ☐ I used the Past Perfect for actions that happened before the main event.
- ☐ I used at least two time expressions correctly.
- ☐ My paragraph has a clear order of events.
- ☐ I checked my spelling and past participle forms.

A Short Biography

130-160 words

Write a short biography paragraph about a real or imaginary person, describing what they had achieved or experienced earlier in their life before a key turning point.

Plan:

1. Choose the person and the turning point in their life you will focus on.
2. Note down two or three things that had happened in their life before that turning point.
3. Organise the events in a logical time order.
4. Write the paragraph and then proofread it for correct tense use.

Checklist:

- ☐ I clearly described what had happened before the turning point.
- ☐ I used the Past Perfect and Simple Past correctly together.
- ☐ I included at least three pieces of theme vocabulary.
- ☐ My biography paragraph is within the word limit.

1. By the time the movie started, we _____ our snacks.
 - a. buy
 - b. bought
 - c. had bought
 - d. have bought
2. It was the first time she _____ (visit) a big city on her own.
3. Before he called me, he had already sent an email. — *True / False*
4. What is the correct meaning of 'milestone' in this theme's context?
 - a. A type of road sign
 - b. An important achievement or point in life
 - c. A kind of old building
 - d. A short holiday
5. The house looked _____ because no one had lived in it for years. (use 'abandoned')
6. According to 'The Teacher Who Never Gave Up', what had Elif done before a position opened at the regional school?
 - a. She had studied abroad.
 - b. She had already built a reputation as a dedicated teacher.
 - c. She had written a textbook.
 - d. She had retired from teaching.
7. In the listening 'Catching Up After Many Years', B had already started his own business by the time he turned thirty. — *True / False*
8. Combine using the Past Perfect: She finished her degree. Then she found a job.
9. Which sentence correctly describes an earlier past action?
 - a. When I got there, the train already left.
 - b. When I got there, the train had already left.
 - c. When I got there, the train leaves already.
 - d. When I got there, the train has already left.
10. Put the words in order: (never / before / that / had / I / tried / food)

Support

1. Write four sentences about your day using 'had already' + past participle, following the model: 'By the time I got to school, I had already had breakfast.'
2. Match five vocabulary words from this theme to their Turkish meanings.
3. Complete four gap-fill sentences with the correct Past Perfect form of the verb given.
4. Read the sentence pairs and mark which action happened first (earlier action = Past Perfect).

Core

1. Write a short paragraph (80-100 words) describing three things that had happened in your life before you turned fifteen.
2. Rewrite five Simple Past sentence pairs as single sentences using the Past Perfect and a suitable time expression.
3. Choose five new vocabulary words from this theme and write an original sentence for each.
4. Answer the reading comprehension questions for 'The Teacher Who Never Gave Up' in full sentences.

Extension

1. Write a 150-word biography paragraph about a family member, focusing on what they had achieved before a key milestone in their life.
2. Record yourself (or write a script) telling a one-minute personal story using at least four Past Perfect sentences.
3. Find or create three example sentences that show the difference between the Past Perfect and the Simple Past in the same context.
4. Write five original test-style questions (mixing MCQ, gap-fill and true/false) about this theme's grammar point for a classmate to answer.

Vocabulary

1. Choose the correct meaning of 'eventually'.
 - a. immediately
 - b. in the end, after some time
 - c. never
 - d. usually
2. She felt _____ when she looked at old photos of her childhood home. (use a word meaning 'full of longing for the past')
3. Which word best fits: 'They had to _____ great hardship before they succeeded.'
 - a. overcome
 - b. witness
 - c. recall
 - d. relocate

Grammar

1. By the time we arrived, the concert _____ (already start).
2. Choose the correct question form.
 - a. Had you ever visit Paris before?
 - b. Have you ever visited Paris before?
 - c. Had you ever visited Paris before?
 - d. Did you had visited Paris before?
3. I hadn't finished my homework when my friend arrived. — *True / False*
4. Combine: The rain stopped. We left the house.

Reading

1. In 'A Return to the Abandoned House', what had happened to the garden by the time Kerem returned?
 - a. It had been replanted.
 - b. It had become overgrown.
 - c. It had been destroyed by fire.
 - d. It had stayed exactly the same.
2. Kerem found an old wooden chest that his family had left behind when they had _____.

Listening

1. In 'A Grandmother's Story', what had the grandmother done before finishing her studies?

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- a. She had got married.
 - b. She had met the grandfather.
 - c. She had moved abroad.
 - d. She had started a business.

2. The grandparents had relocated three times by their first anniversary. — *True / False*